

Tile Explorer by Oakever Games

Deconstruct

1.Core Gameplay Loop

Tile Explorer is a triple match tile puzzle game. Mahjong style (The tiles are only placed on the board similar to the Mahjong style but the core loop differs from the actual Mahjong game).

The tiles are stacked in layers on a board of the location world. The players tap on exposed tiles to place them on a 7 slot horizontal tray like grid at the top. When the player sends 3 identical tiles, they get cleared by getting destroyed. The core loop ends with all tiles cleared and the level is complete or in a loss where all the 7 tray slots are filled without a possible match.

- **Step 1** - The player views the board with tiles stacked. Tiles with no tile directly above are accessible.
- **Step 2** - Player taps on the accessible tile. It slots into the tray at the bottom.
- **Step 3** - When 3 identical tiles land on the tray. They get cleared. (Destroyed animation).
- **Step 4** - The player must avoid filling the 7 slot tray without matching.
- **Step 5** - Clear all tiles to complete the level and get rewarded with coins and progression. Fill the tray and level fails, can continue with ADs or booster.

Core Booster

Booster	Effect	Best Use Case
Undo	Return the last tile back to the board.	Best Use when the wrong tile fills the tray slot.
Instant Match	Instantly send any matching 3 similar tiles to the tray to get cleared.	Gets blocked by obstacles like chocolate boxes.
Re Suffle	Shuffle the board randomly, revealing new access paths.	Best when the tray is near full and there is no visible match.

2. Difficulty Curve

Tile Explorer uses a classic easy to hook, frictionless difficulty curve. This approach is immediately accessible - strategic demand later. This is done so that the player gets hooked with early wins and then introduces friction with ADs and boosters.

- **Tutorial and Onboarding : Level 1 to 10.**

The first two levels are controlled to get the player familiar with the core loop. On the first level 3 tile of the same pattern (No other outcome) easy level win. 2nd Level has 9 tiles. 3 matches (No other Outcome) similar to the first.

Then as the level progresses it becomes 4-6 tile types and single layer to double layer. Still the difficulty is very generous. With Auto hints it's near impossible to fail.

- **Easy : Level 11 to 50**

Increase in tile types to 6-8 and a 3 layered board. From here some planning is needed due to hidden tiles. Can fail but unlikely. Introducing obstacles.

- **Medium : Level 51 to 150**

Tile type becomes 8-10 and the layers become 4. Hidden tiles are increased with increased uncertainty. Increase usage of boosters. Increased the number of obstacles and its types.

- **Hard : Level 151 - 500**

10-12 types of tile with 4-5 layers board with opaque layers. The skill gap between casual and careful players increases. Obstacles increase and the use of boosters also increases.

- **Expert / Endgame : Level 500+**

This has maximum board depth and tile density. High booster consumption drives ad views and IAP.

3. Progression System

The progression of tile explorers is linear. Level number is the progress state.

- Thousands of levels. The level number is always visible on the menu screen as the primary identity marker.
- The level number progression is further divided into scenery (Theme World) progression.
- The ranked mode is time based. It unlocks at 2nd scenery and each tier has its own leaderboard and the player has to place in the top 10 to promote to the next tier.
- The ranked mode runs on the same level as the normal Meta progression. The only difference is ranked specific tiles are substituted with normal tiles.
- Coins are earned per level and from watching ads. These coins are spent on booster refills. This creates a perfect loop of earning and spending.

Positives	Negatives
Hints and free boosters are able to help new players to adapt quicker and learn core loops faster.	If we ignore the first 2 tutorial levels, from the third level the difficulty increase may seem exponential for some very casual players.
Tray management is a mechanic the player has to vary. Creates depth.	Hidden tiles can cause players to actively learn as the tiles are randomized. Which is not skill based.
Different tiles create visual variety without changing the core loop.	The ranked mode can be confusing as its timer based. Being top of the table still not promoting One more system to remember.
Once the player gets past the first 12 levels (First Themed World) then the level meta is linear and forgiving	This can be the negative point as well as the retention depends on the first 12 levels and how welcoming they are for players.
No lives, energy system makes the progression limited only by player level completion speed.	No real reward as the player is only playing for the coins as rewards and no Themed world interaction. Lost feature retention.

4.IAP Model

Tile Explorer is an ad first model. IAP is just a support to the ad revenue rather than the primary revenue driver. The IAP consists mostly of a small number of coins and booster packs with a single no ads pass.

IAP Category	What's Offered	Pricing
Coin Bundles	Various pack sizes of in-game coins.	Starter packs positioned around Rs 39/- to Rs 799/-. Larger bundles up to Rs 1599/-. Standard casual puzzle pricing.
No Ads pass	Removes interstitial and banner ads permanently	Rs 239/- and also grants 300 coins
Booster Bundles	Direct purchase of Undo, Shuffle, Extra in bulk quantities.	Bundled with coin packs rather than standalone purchases. Typical casual puzzle IAP design.
No Seasonal Pass / Battle Pass	Not observed. No subscription tier beyond ad-removal exists at time of analysis.	Significant missed revenue opportunity given download scale.

5.IAP Strategy

IAP depends entirely on friction in gameplay progression. The player hits a hard level, uses a booster and is required to purchase more. This is proactive use of IAP purchase.

- **Fail State Prompt** - On level failure the player is offered a continue option at the cost of a watch ad. No direct IAP is introduced yet.
- **Booster Depletion** - When a booster type runs to zero a refill IAP prompt appears. This is the primary IAP promotion.
- **Store Access** - A Shop button is always accessible from the menu and in game. Non promoting but available on one click.
- **First purchase Offer** - Limited offer of a “starter pack” first purchase discount.
- **No Limited Time Offer** - Missed Opportunity.

Positives	Negative
The coin economy creates a soft, organic IAP demand. Players understand coins = boosters = progress.	Reports - No complete AD removal. No-ads IAP failing to remove ads is a critical trust violation.
Booster centric IAP aligns with player need. Stuck on a level = spend.	Fail state prompt does not include a direct IAP offer. Lost conversion at the highest-intent player moment.
The no-ads IAP is a legitimate monetisation of casual players	No starter pack with time urgency. First-payer conversion rates are likely very low.
Low IAP prices minimise payer hesitation.	No subscription product, subscription conversion = enormous revenue
No pay-to-win. The full game is playable without IAP.	No dynamic pricing or personalised offers. The same IAP is shown to a level 5 player and a level 500 player.

6.Ad Format

Ad monetization is the primary revenue for Tile Explorer. The game is optimized for high ad volume rather than high ARPU. The Ad monetization depends upon a mix of involuntary and Opt in Ads.

Ad Format	Placement	Observation
Interstitial (Full-screen)	Triggered after level completions.	Highest revenue format by impression value. #1 frustration point 'ads after every level.

Rewarded Video (Opt-in)	The player initiated a watch ad to earn coins, a watch ad to shuffle board after failing, and a watch ad to continue after loss.	Best practice placement. High eCPM.
Interstitial on Fail State	After a level failure, the player is shown a 'watch ad to shuffle and continue' prompt.	The ad IS the continue mechanism of It was almost cleared.
Banner Ad	Missed Opportunity.	Missed Opportunity.

7. Ads Player Experience

Tile Explorer has a high volume Ad strategy which is a hyper casual game title. Those types of games are primarily download heavy growth games. The risk is it adds short term ARPU.

Tile Explorers user feedback identifies ad frequency as the most negative experience. This Creates tension and drives players to purchase the no Ads IAP.

Positives	Negatives
Rewarded video integration is best in class with multiple opt-in touchpoints.	Ad frequency appears uncapped. 5–8 ads per session is above the casual puzzle genre.
Interstitial as continue-mechanic on fail state is clever.	Technical ad delivery bugs cause force-restarts and session loss.
High download volume means even mediocre ARPU.	No Ads IAP does not fulfill its purpose and destroys trust.
Global content rating and 16+ language support maximises addressable audience.	Aggressive interstitial frequency is degrading app store ratings over time.
Opt-in video rewards generate higher eCPM than forced interstitials.	No native ad or in-game cosmetic ad integration.